



Thermometer

This lab tool was created to compare all types of temperature changes more accurately, and there are different temperature scales, such as Celsius, Fahrenheit, and Kelvin. The first thermometers were filled with liquids that take up more space and therefore rise up the thermometer as they get warmer, such as mercury (a type of metal).



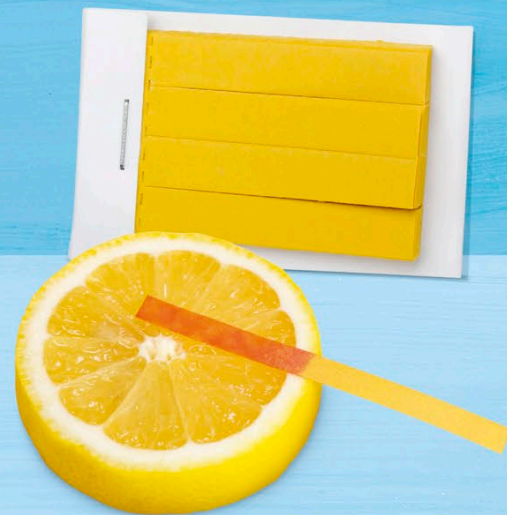
Litmus paper

This is no ordinary piece of paper—it contains a mixture of chemicals extracted from lichen. The mixture turns red in acidic liquids, such as lemon juice, and blue in alkaline liquids, such as soap. This makes it quick and easy to find out if a chemical or mixture is acidic or alkaline!



Microscope

Microscopes let scientists see details that are invisible to our eyes. They have helped us understand what things are made of. The first microscopes bent light to create a bigger picture. Today's most powerful microscopes use beams of electrons instead.



Robert Hooke was one of the first people to make microscopes with more than one or two lenses, which let him see cells for the first time.

Petri dish

These wide, flat dishes were invented by Julius Petri and are used to grow cultures (large groups) of tiny living things, such as cells. The cover makes sure a culture isn't contaminated by other things, and the dishes slide neatly underneath a microscope lens.

